DAPAGLIFLOZIN

Euglycaemic DKA

HF & CKD benefit

CHEMICAL NAME (2S,3R,4R,5S,6R)-2-[4-chloro-3-(4-ethoxybenzyl)phenyl]-6-(hydroxymethyl)oxane-3,4,5-triol (propanediol monohydrate)

CLASS SGLT2 inhibitor (gliflozin)

TRADE NAMES Forxiga · Farxiga · Xigduo (with metformin) · Qtern (with saxagliptin)

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Type 2 diabetes.
- Heart failure (HFrEF and HFpEF) regardless of diabetes.
- Chronic kidney disease (with or without diabetes).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily at any time, with or without food.
- Hold for surgery (3 days before) and acute illness.

DOSAGES

- **All indications:** 10 mg once daily.
- Do not initiate if eGFR <25 (CKD/HF) — continue to dialysis per guidance.
- Glycaemic effect small when eGFR <45.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Peak:** 2 h. **Duration:** 24 h.
- Glucuronidated (UGT1A9).
- Excreted in urine. **t½:** 13 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Inhibits **SGLT2** → glycosuria, natriuresis, osmotic diuresis → ↓ glucose, BP, weight; ↓ intraglomerular pressure (renoprotection).

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Genital infections.
- UTI, polyuria.
- Back pain, dyslipidaemia.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Euglycaemic DKA.
- Volume depletion, hypotension.
- Fournier's gangrene.
- Initial dip in eGFR (expected, haemodynamic).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Type 1 diabetes (not licensed); DKA.
- Hypersensitivity; dialysis (initiation).

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Diuretics:** volume depletion.
- **Insulin, sulfonylureas:** hypoglycaemia.
- **Lithium:** ↓ levels.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Baseline eGFR, BP, fluid status; recheck after start.
- Ketone check if unwell.
- Sick-day and perioperative holds.
- Monitor HF symptoms and weight.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take daily; good genital hygiene.
- Stop when vomiting, dehydrated or before surgery; restart when eating and drinking normally.
- Seek help for symptoms of DKA even with normal glucose.

KEY POINTS

- SGLT2 inhibitor, 10 mg OD.
- Euglycaemic DKA; genital infections.
- HF and CKD protection.
- Sick-day rules.

SOURCES CHECKED **[617]** Dapagliflozin 10 mg film coated tablets (UK SmPC) **[618]** Dapagliflozin, oral (US label) **[619]** Dapagliflozin, oral (US label, Bryant Ranch Prepack)

Full references p. 432–457